NeuralQuant and You, these are some things you need to look at carefully.

1. **Role and title**

   a. **Who are the other partners – Name and Where they are working right now**

   b. **What is the role of each partner**

   c. **You must take the Role as CTO and Co-founder**, not "Head of Technology" or any other sanitised title. CTO signals co-equal founding status to investors. Head of Technology reads as an employee. This distinction shows up in term sheets, media coverage, and in how the board treats his voice five years from now.

      Also – No need to change anything in LinkedIn now, do it after sign-off.

   d. On equity, with 6 partners, the natural temptation is equal splitting. That would be **Wrong** here. NeuralQuant is the entire reason this entity exists — without it, the other five have a consulting firm, not a fintech platform. A floor of **30–35% for you** is defensible, and you should not accept "we'll sort equity later." Later never favours the person who didn't push earlier.

2. **The legal scaffold — non-negotiable before signing anything**

   The single most important document is the **Founders' Agreement / Shareholders' Agreement**, and it must be drafted by a lawyer You/we engage with independently — not a lawyer the group chooses together.

   Key clauses to insist on:

   Before you sign any paper with these 5 partners, certain things must be written into a legal agreement. Think of it as rules that protect you so nobody can cheat you later — intentionally or accidentally.

   i. **"NeuralQuant belongs to me"** You built NeuralQuant *before* this partnership. So the technology — the code, the AI models, everything — is *yours*. The agreement should say clearly: if this company shuts down tomorrow, or if you are forced out, the technology goes back to you. You should not hand over ownership of your creation outright.

   ii. **"Everyone's equity should be earned over time"** Nobody should get their full share on day one. A standard practice is, you earn your equity over 4 years, and if you leave in the first year, you get nothing. This protects you from a situation where someone takes their share and then stops contributing. If other partners resist this, that itself is a red flag.

iii. **"Major tech decisions need my approval"** Since you are the CTO and the tech *is* the product; no one should be able to decide "let's change the AI engine" or "let's replace this system" without your sign-off. This must be written in — not just verbally agreed.

iv. **"If you raise more money, don't dilute only me"** When investors come in and the company issues new shares, everyone's percentage goes down. That's normal. But the agreement must ensure this happens equally — the partners can't structure a deal that reduces your share more than theirs.

v. **"If you sell the company, I get the same deal as everyone else"** If the majority partners decide to sell the company to someone, you must get the same price per share that they get. And critically — check that no clause allows the majority to *force* you to sell against your will at a price they decide.

vi. **The most important practical step:** You should hire your *own* lawyer — someone the group does not pick together. Even a one-time consultation. This is not about distrust. It's like reading the fine print before signing a house agreement. The others would have done deals before. You have not. Your lawyer's job is simply to make sure you don't unknowingly sign away something you'll regret.

3. The investor pitch dynamic

i. **You MUST present the product in every investor meeting, without exception.** The conversational AI agent is a live demo opportunity — something intuitive that the other partners literally cannot replicate. This is where this becomes an asset, not a liability: investors fund founders who can build, and a 22-year-old demoing a live AI agent in a fintech platform is a story.

ii. The narrative he should own: "**I built the core. My partners bring the market access and regulatory depth. Together we've collapsed the go-to-market timeline from years to months.**" That framing positions the other partners as catalyst of *your* platform, not co-owners of a shared idea.

iii. **One practical ask for the pitch:** *insist that the pitch deck's cover slide and founder bios section show **You as CTO-Founder**,* and that the tech section is narrated by you. If partners rewrite his sections or downplay the AI component to make it "sound more mainstream" for traditional finance investors, push back hard.

4. **Managing the age dynamic day-to-day**
   i. The risk isn't ill will — it's a slow, well-intentioned erosion. Experienced people in their 40s instinctively pattern-match you to a "young developer" they've worked with before. The antidote is consistent, structured leadership behaviour:
      a. You should publish a **tech roadmap document quarterly** — a 12-month view of what's being built, what's being deprecated, and what the AI capability milestones are. This single habit repositions you from "the person who writes code" to "the person who sets direction."
      b. All verbal decisions in founder meetings should be confirmed via a brief email same day. Not as a trust mechanism — frame it as "just keeping records clean for the company." This creates an audit trail that protects you if a disagreement arises later about who agreed to what.
      c. You should find a personal advisor (We have Basanta)— ideally a fintech/IT founder or MD/CEO/CTO — who has no or little equity stake in this venture. Someone you can call when the group dynamics feel off. My perspective will also be valuable, but I also needs someone who's been inside a similar founding team.

5. **Pitfalls to watch — the less obvious ones**
   i. **The gradual scope creep.** The market-savvy partners will start suggesting "the AI should just do X differently because clients want Y." This is healthy input when it's genuinely from client discovery. It becomes a problem when it's them rewriting the product vision based on their intuitions from pre-AI consulting. You should welcome market feedback and filter it through a product spec process — not let it arrive as verbal directives.

   ii. **The salary gap pre-revenue.** If the five experienced partners draw ₹2–3L/month each during the pre-revenue phase (which they may justify via "market experience and client relationships"), and you draw a nominal salary, the company burns through its ₹3.5 Cr raise in under a year while you carry the technical load. Agree on a **uniform or near-uniform founder salary structure** until Series A, with a deferred compensation mechanism for the differential.

   iii. **The "we should outsource this" conversation.** As the platform scales, there will be pressure to replace you custom models with off-the-shelf Bloomberg API, or your portfolio engine with a vendor SDK. Sometimes this is right. Often, it's a cost-saving move that also happens to reduce your irreplaceability. You should evaluate each case on technical merit — and ensure the Founders' Agreement gives you CTO veto on such substitutions.

iv. **The "you're still in university" framing.** You are completing your Master's. The team will want to close clients and move fast. There will be pressure to deprioritise your thesis, or conversely to hold the venture back while you finish. You need to set a clear boundary: your academic timeline is fixed, and the startup launch sequence should be planned around it explicitly, not treated as an afterthought.

v. **The emotional override.** At 22, in a room of experienced professionals, it's very easy to *give in* on important decisions because of social pressure — not because you're wrong, but because five confident voices feel overwhelming. The solution is preparation: You should never walk into a founder meeting on an important agenda item without having written out your position in advance. *A person who shows up with a documented view holds ground far more easily than one who thinks on the fly.*

The conversational AI agent — pitch it aggressively

This is genuinely the most investor-ready feature they have right now. Generative AI as a portfolio advisor and market intelligence interface is a credible wedge into the wealth management segment — particularly relevant given SEBI's evolving stance on robo-advisory regulation.

You should position it not as a feature but as the **primary delivery mechanism** for NeuralQuant's intelligence. The pitch narrative: "We don't just give you data. The platform converses with you about your portfolio."

This is the moat. This is what the others cannot replicate. This is what you should walk into every investor room ready to demo, live, no slides required.